I'm 44 And I Haven't Had A Cheat Day In 4 Years

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 24, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/0YImZsYi-eI Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter argues that cheat days backfire by resetting cravings weekly, requiring extra willpower for days afterward. Cutting them out entirely made cravings disappear — abstinence proved easier than moderation.

📑 Contents

- 🍕 The Cheat Day Cycle and Its Hidden Cost
- 💡 The Decision to Stop and What Happened Next
- ⚖️ Abstinence vs. Moderation: The Core Principle

🍕 The Cheat Day Cycle and Its Hidden Cost 0:00

- Brandon used to schedule cheat meals around Sunday American football games
  - On those days he would, by his own description, "eat like an [expletive]"
- The immediate aftermath was the real problem — not the cheat day itself
  - For **48 to 72 hours** after a cheat day, cravings for those foods were significantly elevated
  - He didn't give in to those cravings, but he noticed he needed far more discipline during that window than at any other point in the week
- The cycle kept resetting itself
  - He would finally adapt to his diet and the cravings would fade
  - Then Sunday would come, another cheat day would happen, and the entire craving cycle would restart
  - He repeated this pattern "for years"

💡 The Decision to Stop and What Happened Next 0:24

- The turning point was a simple question he asked himself: "What if I just stopped having cheat days?"
  - He had connected the dots — the cheat days themselves were inducing the cravings
- The result was immediate and clear: the cravings went away entirely
- He illustrates this with a real-life test — his son's birthday party
  - He was slicing cake for the children and felt **zero desire** to eat it
  - "I don't even want it. The cravings aren't there."

⚖️ Abstinence vs. Moderation: The Core Principle 0:48

- His conclusion is stated directly: **"Abstinence is easier than moderation."**
- The logic: having the off-limits food even once reignites the craving cycle
  - "If I have the cake that one time, I'm going to want the cake after"
- The practical implication is that maintaining a strict no-cheat policy requires less total willpower over time than allowing periodic indulgences, because it never reactivates the craving response